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SECURITY
INFORMATION

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STATUS REPORT

PROJECT BLUE BOOK - REPORT NO. 5

FORMERLY PROJECT GRUDGE

PROJECT NO. 10073

31 MARCH 1952

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Wright-Patterson Air Force Base
Dayton, Ohio

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AUTH: CO, ATIC *ER*

BY: E.J. RUPPELT
1st Lt, USAF

DATE 9 Apr 52

This report is the fifth of a series of monthly status reports of Project Blue Book. Each report is written on or near the last day of the month and will contain a list of all incidents reported during the month covered by the report. The reports that are considered outstanding will be summarized in the appendices of the report so that more details can be presented. The overall status of the project will be presented.

Any additional information may be obtained on any incident by directing requests to Chief, Air Technical Intelligence Center, Attn: ATIAA-2c, Wright-Patterson Air Force Base, Dayton, Ohio.

The security classification of this report is Secret due only to the inclosure of reports that were classified Secret by the originating agency and due to the fact that allied information pertaining to the project is Secret. The classification of each separate incident is noted with the incident.

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STATUS OF PROJECT BLUE BOOK

I. OVERALL STATUS

A. Change of Project Nickname

The nickname of the project, which was formerly "Grudge", has been officially changed to "Blue Book".

B. Directive for Reporting Incidents

A proposed directive to replace the AFOIN-C/CC-2 directive dated 19 December, 1951, subject, "Reporting of Information on Unconventional Aircraft", has been coordinated with ATIC and forwarded to D/I for approval.

This directive is similar to the directive of 19 December 1951 except it will require that all reports be made by wire to ATIC, ADC, and V/TC and that these wire reports be followed up by an Air Force Form 112 sent directly to ATIC and V/TC. Past experience has shown that in order to carry our investigations successfully ATIC must be informed of sightings immediately, by direct channels.

C. Holloman Report

Project Blue Book has recently received a copy of a report written by personnel of Holloman AFB, New Mexico. This report, dated 25 July 1951, compiles the results of an investigation of unidentified aerial phenomena carried out at Holloman AFB.

The project consisted of an organized watch for the objects, the watchers being equipped with cameras. Several photos were obtained with hand held cameras. The photos show only a round image with no details for identification. On two occasions objects were photographed with Askania theodolites, once on 27 April 1950 and again on 29 May 1950. The results were not satisfactory, however, and no data could be obtained because in the first instance only one station was tracking and in the second instance two stations tracked two different objects.

The report makes no conclusions as to the identity of the objects. However, it does establish the fact that some type of object did exist.

Action will be taken by Project Blue Book to establish liaison with Holloman AFB and determine if any additional results have been obtained.

D. Life Article on Unidentified Aerial Objects

Mr. Robert Ginna of the Life Magazine Staff visited ATIC on 3 March 1952 to obtain material for an article which will appear in Life on 4 April 1952. He was very familiar with this subject as he has spent a great deal of time in research. The article has been coordinated with Hq USAF.

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One interesting aspect of the visit by Mr. Ginna was the fact that Life has information on several sightings by highly qualified observers that were unknown to ATIC. These people, all civilians, had not reported their observations to any military sources, consequently, ATIC did not have the reports. With the exception of these and several more minor reports, ATIC did have information on all of the incidents that he inquired about.

It is believed that Mr. Ginna's contact with the Air Force established an excellent source of material in that Life has representatives all over the world and these people are sending reports to Life as a matter of routine. ATIC will have access to these reports.

E. Visit by Dr. Joseph Kaplan

On 7 March 1952, Dr. Joseph Kaplan, Professor of Physics at UCLA and a member of the AF Scientific Advisory Board visited ATIC to discuss methods of obtaining more factual information on the reported unidentified aerial objects than has been obtained in the past. His primary interest is the "Green Fireball" phenomena, but the methods he suggested can be applied to any object.

Dr. Kaplan's suggestion is to use spectrum analysis as an aid in identifying the objects. Any object that emits light will have a definite spectrum. The first step in Dr. Kaplan's suggested plan is to obtain the spectrum of the object. This spectrum is then matched with the spectrum of known objects such as meteors, stars, etc., to eliminate or establish the fact that they are known objects. If the objects are not astronomical bodies and spectrum will give some indication as to what they might be. For example, a spectrum of an exhaust trail would show the composition of the exhaust. These examples apply to night sightings in general; however, bright objects appearing in the daytime could be analyzed in a similar manner. If the object were reflecting light instead of emitting it, the spectrum would be the same as that of the sun. Then it would be a case of establishing whether or not there was an aircraft in the area.

The system will afford a means of determining whether or not reported objects are actually some new type of aircraft or merely misidentification of known objects. This suggested system would not completely fulfill the requirements of the project, however, it is a quick, economical means of obtaining more concrete information than now exists and is considered a first step in the investigation.

To obtain the spectrum of the objects, two methods have been suggested. One is the use of a comparatively large (8" x 8") diffraction grating. The observer upon seeing an object would hold up the grating and observe the object through the grating. A means would be provided for marking the observed spectrum on the grating. This would then be sent to some expert for analysis. The second method, and the one under consideration would be to construct an inexpensive hand held camera with a diffraction grating over the lens. With this method a permanent record of the observation would be obtained.

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The gratings or grating camera combinations would be inexpensive enough so that several hundred could be procured. Areas where observations have been concentrated would be stressed. Groups such as security patrols, control tower operators, and anyone who spends a great deal of time out-of-doors would be equipped with the instruments and be given a set of instructions as to how to use them.

Action has been taken to determine the feasibility of such a program.

F. Air Defense Command and Joint Air Defense Board Briefing

On 19 March 1952, General Chidlaw and his staff, of the Air Defense Command, and General Gardner and his staff, of the Joint Air Defense Board, were briefed by an ATIC briefing team. The groups were briefed on the history and operations of Project Blue Book and a member of the Aircraft Performance and Characteristics Branch of ATIC presented data on missiles and types of unconventional aircraft that are known to exist or have existed.

The purpose of the briefing was to present the problem to ADC and determine how they can help. It was found that ADC presently has about 30 radar sites equipped with scope cameras. These cameras are not operational on a 24-hour basis but this could be accomplished in a minimum time particularly in locations of special interest to Project Blue Book. Radar scope photographs would be of great value in interpreting some of the unusual radar returns that are reported.

Action has been taken to initiate a program with ADC to utilize their radar facilities.

G. Beacon Hill Group Briefing

The Beacon Hill Group, Air Force Technical Advisers, were briefed on 26 March 1952 in Boston. This group, consisting of AF consultants in the fields of electronics, optics, acoustics, data collation and other fields, was briefed so that they would have an understanding of the problems confronting Project Blue Book and could offer suggestions. After the briefing several hours were spent discussing the project. The main point of the discussion was to arrive at some means of establishing whether or not there is some unusual type of aircraft flying over the United States.

Several very excellent suggestions were offered. One was to employ sound detection apparatus in the locations where concentrations of sightings have been reported. This equipment, which is very sensitive to sound, can be left unattended eliminating the problem of personnel for a continual watch. Sounds from aircraft, wind, insects, etc., can be identified, consequently, if the apparatus were placed far enough from a populated area and highway to eliminate a large percentage of the sounds, any unknown sound would be of value in indicating the presence of an unidentified object. It is understood that this equipment is available.

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The problem of photographic equipment was discussed. It was found that almost any type of photographic surveillance equipment desired could be built, however, some of it would be expensive. The question of the ability of large astronomical observatories detecting any unusual objects with any of their telescopes or meteor cameras was brought up. It was agreed that their chances of observing an object at random was low, unless they knew of its presence and directed their equipment toward it. This was very interesting because some people have had the theory that no unusual objects could exist because they would have been detected by observatories. In the future, cameras, professionally termed "patrol cameras", will be developed that can detect such objects, but this development is not contemplated in the near future.

Another suggestion offered by the group was to go back through old newspaper files and other sources and try to determine whether or not this phenomena is new. This has been done by several authors but the sources of some of these reports are doubtful. The group believed that if such phenomena as disk-shaped objects, green fireballs, etc., did occur they would have been reported and would be recorded.

This group, all of whom were experts in their fields, were very much interested in the problems of trying to identify these objects and can be counted upon for aid as problems arise.

II. REPORTS OF SPECIFIC INCIDENTS

A. Inclosed Summary List of Incidents

The inclosed list of incidents is (1) a summary of all incidents reported during the period 1 March 1952 to 31 March 1952; and (2) those incidents reported in Status Report No. 4, dated 29 February 1952, which are still pending or have been closed during the month.

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DATE	TIME (Local)	LOCATION	DESCRIPTION OF INC
May to Sept 1947	—	USSR	Dark red fireball, which turned to pale green to white S.E. of Tashkent, USSR. (See Appendix I.) (Secret)
4 Jan 52	0500	Travis AFB, Calif.	Source observed bright green tear drop shaped object The object had a long trail of red flame which seemed sparks. (Restricted)
20 Jan 52	1920	*Fairchild AFB, Wash.	Sources observed circular blue-white light with blue appear in "spurts". (See Appendix II). (Restricted)
11 Feb 52	1210	Kansas City, Mo.	Source reported circular object near high flying B-3 (Confidential)
11 Feb 52	0300	Pittsburgh, Pa.	Two pilots of T-11 aircraft observed a brilliant yellow pulsating flame, flying on a reciprocal heading. (S
12 Feb 52	2030	Washington, D.C. Area	Two pilots observed white light on two occasions one IV.) (Restricted)
13 Feb 52	1545 Z	31° 45'N 159° 10'E	MATS crew observed unidentified aircraft flying parallel turned across their flight path. Possibilities of f doubtful. (Secret)
25 Feb 52	1100	El Paso, Texas	Source allegedly obtained photos of two unidentified a rainbow. (See Appendix V.) (Restricted)
27 Feb 52	2230	Between Ft. Stockton and Pecos, Texas	Radar operator of B-29 flying at 15,500 ft. picked up radar scope. Rate of closure was three times that of
4 Mar 52	0351	England	B-29 left gunner noted extremely bright flash in sky at 17,500 ft. (Secret)
7 Mar 52	0100	Between Tulsa and Claremore, Oklahoma	Bright white light noted crossing 90° to path of C-54 aircraft except no navigation lights were noted. On out. (Restricted)
12 Mar 52	1815	Columbus, Ohio	Long, shiny, apparently wingless object with a pink (Restricted)
13 Mar 52	0722 Z	Iceland	Unidentified return on GCA scope. (Secret)

* Previously reported in Status Report No. 4

SIGHTINGS OF UNIDENTIFIED OBJECTS

DESCRIPTION OF INCIDENT.	LENGTH OF TIME OBSERVED	SOURCE OF INFORMATION	INCIDENT
turned to pale green to white. Observed from point 50 Km (See Appendix I.) (Secret)	—	—	White. (Secret)
seen tear drop shaped object descending through a cloud cover. All of red flame which seemed to shoot out large colored	15-30 Sec.	None	Not described. (Secret)
blue-white light with blue trail. The trail appeared to (See Appendix II). (Restricted)	2 Sec.	None	Blue trail. (Secret)
object near high flying B-36. (See Appendix III.)	10 Min.	—	B-36.
ft observed a brilliant yellow-orange light, trailing a a reciprocal heading. (Secret)	1 Min.	—	Yellow-orange. (Secret)
light on two occasions one half hour apart. (See Appendix	2 Min.	—	One half hour.
tified aircraft flying parallel to their a/c. Aircraft then t path. Possibilities of friendly a/c in the area was	5 Min.	—	Parallel. (Secret)
photos of two unidentified objects while photographing V.) (Restricted)	—	—	Unidentified objects.
ying at 15,500 ft. picked up unidentified object on the sure was three times that of B-29. (Confidential)	—	—	Picked up unidentified object. (Confidential)
tremely bright flash in sky behind a/c which was flying	—	—	Very bright flash.
crossing 90° to path of C-54. Object appeared to be another tion lights were noted. Object descended and light went	—	—	Crossing 90° to path of C-54. Object appeared to be another. (Secret)
ingless object with a pinkish-red flame to the rear.	Unknown	None	Pinkish-red flame.
A scope. (Secret)	57 Min.	—	Scope. (Secret)

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OUND	SPEED	ALTITUDE	HEADING	SOURCE	ACTION OR COMMENT
---	---	---	SSE	---	See Appendix I.
one	Same as jet a/c	Low	90°	Airman.	Description resembled large meteor.
one	High	Low	---	Two Airmen	See Appendix II
---	Low	High	180°	Civilian	Probably a balloon. See Appendix III.
---	Same as jet	High	180°	Two AF pilots	Description similar to meteor.
---	Varied	8,000 ft.	Varied	Two AF pilots	See Appendix IV.
---	200 MPH	9,500 ft.	120° to 360°	MATS C-54 crew	Unidentified conventional aircraft.
---	---	---	---	AF Captain	Objects on photographic print due to flaws in negative. Appendix V.
---	3 x B-29	Lower than 15,500 ft.	---	B-29 Radar Operator	Conclusions pending. Radar photos have been requested.
---	---	---	---	B-29 Crewman	None - information too neb
---	Moderate	10,000 ft.	360°	RAF Wing Commander	Possibly aircraft with no navigation lights. No further investigation.
long	30,000 ft.	High	135°	Newspaper Reporter	Object was identified as aircraft. The setting sun the vapor trail to appear
---	250 K	8,000 ft.	Varied	GCA Crew	Possibly Soviet recon (evaluation by ADC).

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APPENDIX I

Tashkent, USSR - May to September 1947

I. DESCRIPTION OF INCIDENT

During a period from May to September of 1947, a source observed three light phenomena almost every night between the hours of 2100 and 2200 and 2200 local time. The phenomena which occurred at 15 minute intervals were seen SSE of Pakhta Aral, which is about 31 miles SW of Tashkent, USSR (41° 18' N - 69° 15' E).

The phenomena first appeared as a large dark red ball of fire. After about six seconds it reached the apex of a long trajectory, during which time it developed a trail of fire. As the ball of fire descended from the apex of the trajectory, it changed from red to pale green, to white. Smoke trails, noises, or detonations were not heard nor seen. At the apex of the trajectory and object seemed to be about one-fifth the diameter of a full moon.

II. STATUS OF INVESTIGATION

No further investigation or interrogation is possible. Report is evaluated as F-3. This report was submitted to Project Blue Book because of the green color which might possibly relate to "Green Fireballs".

III. CONCLUSIONS

No conclusions can be made due to the nebulous nature of the information. This report was submitted to the Fuels Group and Guided Missiles Group of ATIC. Both agreed that the object was not a liquid fuel missile, however, it could have been a smaller solid fuel rocket.

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APPENDIX II

Fairchild AFB, Washington - 20 January 1952

I. DESCRIPTION OF INCIDENT

At approximately 1920 MST on 20 January 1952, two Wing Intelligence airmen noticed a bright spherical object traveling through the sky. At first it was assumed to be a meteor but then it was noted that it appeared to be traveling beneath a cloud layer. The object was traveling at a speed much faster than a jet aircraft. The object, which made no sound, was traveling in a path horizontal to the earth at an estimated 500 feet and left a blue trail. The trail seemed to come from the object in spurts. The object disappeared from sight behind a building.

The two airmen observers, a Tech Sergeant and Master Sergeant are considered reliable observers.

II. STATUS OF INVESTIGATION

This incident is interesting due to the fact that there was an eight-tenths cloud coverage at 4,700 ft. It is possible that the object was viewed between a break in the clouds and that it was extremely high, indicating that the sighting was a meteor. However, the sources indicated that they believed the object was below the cloud cover, and if this is true the slant range of the object can be computed to be about 7,300 ft. This would eliminate the possibility of the lighted object being a conventional aircraft, since no sound was heard. The possibility of a meteor is also nil because a meteor would not be traveling horizontally at 7,300 ft.

A request was made for the angular measurement of the arc made by the object, however, this information could not be obtained. It is presumed that the sources were not available for questioning.

III. CONCLUSIONS

If the object was beneath the cloud cover it was not a conventional aircraft or meteor, and no conclusions can be made as to its identity.

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APPENDIX III

Kansas City, Missouri - 11 February 1952

I. DESCRIPTION OF INCIDENT

On 11 February 1952, between 1205 and 1215 CST the source, a civilian woman, was watching a B-36 fly from East to West over Kansas City. While watching the B-36, she noticed a round bright object just north of the vapor trail left by the aircraft. The object was observed for ten minutes through 6 x 30 binoculars and during this period it drifted over the observer and continued south of Kansas City.

II. STATUS OF INVESTIGATION

Two balloons were launched in the general area prior to the time of sighting. A piball balloon was launched from Fort Leavenworth, Kansas, at 0930 CST and a Rawinsonde balloon was launched from Fairfax Airport, Kansas City, at 1130 CST. It is doubtful if the balloon launched at 0930 would be in the area at 1205 CST as they usually burst within an hour after the launching.

The balloon launched at 1130 CST could have been observed, however. In the 35 minutes between the time of the balloon launch and the observation, the balloon would have ascended to approximately 30,000 feet and would have traveled approximately 15 miles. (The wind was from 315° and averaged about 30 knots.) This would mean that the balloon passed near the source. If some allowance is made for an error in time, it is very possible that the balloon could have passed directly over the observer. (See inclosed overlay.)

The fact that it could be observed at 30,000 ft. is probably due to the fact that the sun caused the balloon to glow.

III. CONCLUSIONS

The object observed by the source was very possibly a Rawinsonde balloon launched from Fairfax Airport.

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Sherman AFB



Ft. Leavenworth, Kansas

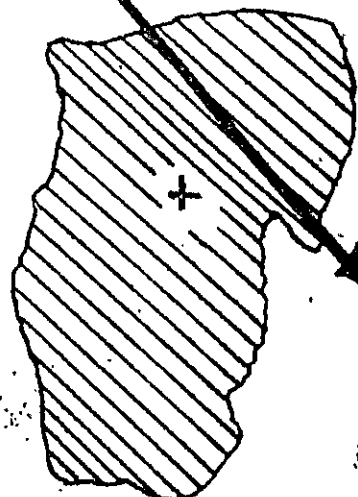
Fairfax Airport



Path of Balloon



Approximate location
of observer



Kansas City

OVERLAY OF KANSAS CITY LOCAL AREA CHART

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APPENDIX IV

Washington, D. C. Area - 12 February 1952

I. DESCRIPTION OF INCIDENT

On 12 February 1952, two MATS pilots flying a C-47 on a local flight observed a bright white object which appeared to be at 7,500 ft. to 8,500 ft. and about one-sixth the size of a rising moon.

The object was observed twice. The first time at 2030 EST, the C-47 was between Baltimore and Baltimore Friendship Airport. The object was estimated to be eight to ten miles away traveling slowly for a moment but then accelerated very rapidly and disappeared southwest of Washington, D. C.

The second time the object was observed was at about 2100 EST, the C-47 was about ten miles south of Baltimore at the time. The object appeared to approach Washington from the south and east, making a left turn toward the city. When it was within two or three miles ESE of Washington, it appeared to hover for about one minute and then it disappeared.

In both instances the object was observed for two or three minutes.

II. STATUS OF INVESTIGATION

The description of this incident is very similar to the one reported on 28 December 1951 that proved to be a helicopter carrying experimental lighting. However, checks on local traffic did not reveal a helicopter in the area on this date.

III. CONCLUSIONS

None.

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APPENDIX V

El Paso, Texas

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25 February 1952

I. DISCUSSION OF INCIDENT

This report contained a photograph of two very unusual objects. The source, an AF Captain, stated that he was attempting to photograph "a circle" that he observed near a rainbow. The "circle" disappeared but he took a picture anyway. Upon developing, or having the negatives developed, two circular objects, similar in appearance to the planet, Saturn, were noticed.

II. STATUS OF INVESTIGATION

Examination of the negative under a microscope showed that the images on the print were caused by two damaged spots on the negative. The cause of these damaged spots is unknown but it appeared that the emulsion had been heated or burned as it was brownish in color. The spots could also have been due to something touching the emulsion while it was still in a gelatin state.

III. CONCLUSIONS

The images on the print were due to damaged spots on the negative.

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